

Philipp Hilbert. *Lead Product Manager, trading and financial infrastructure.*

Positioning, I have shipped regulated fintech products from zero to production, and I know how to read a spec, argue a position, and carry a decision through delivery.

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§ WHY TRADING 212

Trading 212 is one of the few retail brokers that takes product seriously enough to put a co-founder in the interview loop. The job description asks for someone who reads the regulation before Legal does, forms a position, and owns the outcome, that is how I have worked across every regulated product I have shipped. The crypto, payments and tax-efficient investing areas you are hiring for are exactly where my experience sits. *That is the work I want to be doing.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo specs and edge-case generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, day-to-day coding and review
- **Cursor**, codebase-level refactors
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **GPT**, document and data drafts, checked against primary sources
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation
- **Framer**, design-heavy interface work
- **Gamma.app**, structured stakeholder decks

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Docker, GitOps, Jenkins, CI/CD, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Kafka, Dagster, dbt, SQL, GitLab, Azure DevOps, Jira, Confluence, Figma.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Two-sided B2B marketplace for construction staffing, built zero to one.

- Anonymity-until-payment model that protects both sides until commitment is made.
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as the product surface; LLM agents across the funnel so one person runs the day-to-day.
 - Funnel and conversion tracking built in SQL from scratch.
 - Demonstrates the ability to own a regulated, trust-sensitive product end to end, which maps directly to Trading 212's onboarding and client money areas.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT TRADING 212

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

I sit with the engineers, compliance team and existing specs for the areas I own, order routing, settlement, or whichever crypto and payments domains are assigned, and map every decision that is currently undocumented or contested.

WEEK 2

Find the first ship.

I identify the smallest complete thing in my area that unblocks another team or closes a regulatory gap, write a spec detailed enough to build and test from, and align Engineering and Compliance on it.

WEEK 3 +

Ship, then review.

I carry the first launch through to production, then turn attention to reviewing the other PMs' open specs and research, looking for the rounding rules and edge cases that tend to cause problems later.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Trading 212 team,

I am applying for the Lead Product Manager role. I have spent 13 years shipping products in regulated industries, fintech, defence AI, public-sector analytics, insurance, healthcare, and the work you describe in this posting is the kind I do best: reading the regulation yourself, forming a position before Legal weighs in, writing a spec that engineering can build and test from, and owning the outcome.

The closest thing I have to the trading and execution area in your job description is my fintech background. I founded Kvitt Payment Solutions, a mobile P2P payments product that was acquired by Sparkasse and operated inside the girocard ecosystem. I have spent years as an active crypto trader across centralised and decentralised venues, Hyperliquid, Bitget, Jupiter, 1inch, Across Protocol, and I work regularly with execution concepts like slippage, price impact, routing and market microstructure. That is not just user-level familiarity; I have built a backtesting engine and algorithmic decision frameworks for crypto markets, and I spend real time with liquidation heatmaps and tools like Coinglass and Hyblock Capital.

On the data side: at the Bundesagentur für Arbeit I owned a national labour-market analytics platform. I queried the data myself, introduced Dagster and dbt to automate quarterly imports, and cut the time per data update by almost 75%. At Rohde & Schwarz I instrumented two competing product workflows to decide which one to build, the beautiful UI-led one recorded exactly zero real clicks, and redirecting strategy based on that data increased pipeline runs by 200%. I bring my own numbers and I can explain every figure I quote.

The payments area you list, onboarding, client money, cards and FX, maps to work I have done at multiple points: Kvitt's P2P payment flows, the procurement webshop I ran for AOK across three insurers and 20,000 employees, and the client-trust and compliance work at EMIL Group where I restructured an 18-person delivery organisation and shipped the Claims Center from concept to production. The pattern across all of those is the same: complex operational workflow, regulatory weight, cross-functional alignment, and a spec detailed enough that nothing breaks at the edges.

I use AI in product work daily, Claude Code for specs and edge-case generation, Cursor and GitHub Copilot in the codebase, n8n for agentic automation, but I check everything against documentation and data before it leaves my hands. I am ready to talk through any of these projects in detail, including where they broke.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ PROFILE

Product manager and product owner with 13 years of product ownership in fintech, payments, regulated B2B SaaS, defence AI and public-sector analytics. I run continuous discovery, turn strategy, user needs and technical constraints into requirements and a prioritised roadmap, and lead cross-functional teams through agile delivery (Scrum, Kanban, SAFe).

§ HOW I WORK

- I leave my ego at home. I want to drive the decision, not to have the last word.
 - On a new product I spend a little to learn before spending a lot to build. Cheap experiments make expensive decisions safe(r).
 - Outcome over output. Producing something is not the achievement; it also has to fit a market, so I agree what would count as success before we build and check afterwards whether it happened.
 - I keep the whole value chain in view, not just the backlog. Defect-to-fix time is a product metric; architects and DevOps engineers build that chain, my job is to steer it into the right lanes.
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§ WORK EXPERIENCE

PRODUCT MANAGER, ROHDE & SCHWARZ, MUNICH / REMOTE |
07/2024-05/2025

Defence and aerospace. Internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme.

- Instrumented two competing product workflows; redirected strategy based on the data and increased pipeline runs by 200%, the UI-led alternative recorded exactly zero real clicks.

- Championed GitOps delivery with ArgoCD, cutting rollout time from days to 30 minutes and making the platform hotfix-capable across multinational teams.
- Led a cross-functional team of 15+ engineers and data scientists through Scrum in Jira and Confluence.

PRODUCT MANAGER, BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT, NUREMBERG /
REMOTE | 05/2023-07/2024

Public sector. National labour-market analytics platform for policymakers and researchers. Deputy IT Security Officer.

- Introduced Dagster and dbt so quarterly imports and new indicators ran without hand-holding, saving almost 75% of the time per data update.
- Migrated a bare-metal system fully into containers, giving the team autonomous control of its environments, and carried a full UI relaunch and large ETL migration in the same period.

PRODUCT OWNER, CLINET PLATFORMS, BERLIN | 01/2023-07/2023

Healthcare. Mobile patient app for iOS and Android, piloted in hospitals.

- Cut the roadmap to the top 10% of features against agreed success measures: user acceptance rose more than fivefold.
- Implemented the CGM interface into hospital KIS workflows: digital anamnesis dropped from 30 minutes to 5.

PRODUCT MANAGER, EMIL GROUP, BERLIN | 04/2022-12/2022

Insurance. B2B SaaS platform for insurers, reinsurers, brokers and underwriters.

- Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams: attrition fell from near-total exodus to a single departure.
- Shipped the Claims Center from concept to production with no precedent, and cut time-to-market for a new insurance product from months to less than a week.

PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION TEAM, SCHEIDT & BACHMANN,
MÖNCHENGLADBACH | 09/2021-03/2022

Retail and payments. POS and forecourt systems.

- Moved research results into production across a matrix organisation in a full SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM), BUNDESDRUCKEREI, BERLIN |
03/2021-06/2021

Government secure data platform.

- Data structures and identity management for the Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY), AOK ITSCARE, FRANKFURT | 03/2019-05/2020

Health insurance. B2B procurement webshop.

- Migrated a legacy system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and roughly 20,000 employees; still in production.
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§ FOUNDER TRACK

FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER, CONSTRUCT8, LIMASSOL | 12/2025-PRESENT

Construction staffing. Two-sided B2B marketplace.

- Built zero to one: anonymity-until-payment model, WhatsApp and Telegram as the product surface, LLM agents across the funnel, funnel and conversion analysis in SQL.

CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER, QCRYPT AG, BERLIN | 01/2016-12/2021

IT security. Quantum-secure encryption hardware and software.

- Shipped a three-layer product that installs in under two minutes. Later Chair of the board.

FOUNDER AND CFO, KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS, BERLIN | 02/2013-11/2018

Fintech. Mobile group-based P2P payments.

- Built from zero to acquisition: acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.
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§ SKILLS

Product Ownership: requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, definition of done, epics, backlog refinement, sprint planning, story-point estimation, velocity and burndown, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision and roadmap, prioritisation, MVP, PoC, A/B testing, user research and interviews, prototyping, product lifecycle management, go-to-market support.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Agile, Scrum, Kanban, SAFe (Scaled Agile Framework), ART (agile release train), PI (program increment) planning.

Analytics and Data: funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, data querying (SQL, PostgreSQL), ETL, Dagster, dbt, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt and context engineering, evaluation loops, human-in-the-loop design, AI governance, EU AI Act; Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable, n8n.

Payments and Crypto: P2P payment flows, PSP integration, girocard ecosystem, crypto market microstructure, CEX/DEX mechanics, perpetuals, DEX aggregation, cross-chain bridging, execution quality analysis.

Technical Environments Owned: Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Docker, GitOps, Jenkins, CI/CD, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Kafka, GitLab, Azure DevOps.

Governance and Business: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership and financial planning as CFO, ROI reasoning.

§ EDUCATION

DIPLOM-WIRTSCHAFTSINGENIEUR (INDUSTRIAL ENGINEERING AND MANAGEMENT, EQUIVALENT TO A MASTER'S DEGREE), TECHNISCHE UNIVERSITÄT BERLIN (TU BERLIN), GERMANY | 10/2006-09/2014

- Specialisation: Logistics. Thesis with Siemens AG Energy Service on balancing-power market profitability.

§ LANGUAGES

German (native speaker, C2) · English (C2, business and technical fluency)

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